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LEARNER GUIDE

For

ITIL 4 Foundation Training

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1.0	21 July 2026	Initial non-WSQ release (C348), mirrored from the ITIL 4 Foundation master courseware: five topics across three days, eight group labs on the BrightDesk Services scenario, and exam preparation for the included ITIL 4 Foundation exam voucher.	Dr Alfred Ang
1.1	21 July 2026	Course title simplified to 'ITIL 4 Foundation Training' (voucher wording removed from the document covers; the voucher itself is unchanged).	Dr Alfred Ang
13.0	21 July 2026	Trainer deck replaced with the full 259-slide SG master deck (v12 lineage), adapted for the C348 short course: programme-only admin content and framework code references removed, cover retitled. Version aligned to the master-deck lineage across LP and LG.	Dr Alfred Ang

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Introduction.....	4
Course Learning Outcomes.....	4
Before You Start — Preparation.....	4
Topic 01 — Understand Key Concepts of Service Management (25%).....	5
Lab 1 — Service Management, Value Co-Creation, Utility and Warranty.....	5
Topic 02 — ITIL Guiding Principles (20%).....	6
Lab 2 — Seven Guiding Principles and Decision Scenarios.....	6
Topic 03 — The Four Dimensions of Service Management (15%).....	7
Lab 3 — Four Dimensions of Service Management.....	7
Topic 04 — The Service Value System (20%).....	8
Lab 4 — Service Value System and Service Value Chain.....	8
Topic 05 — ITIL Practices (20%).....	9
Lab 5 — Incident, Problem, Service Request, Service Desk.....	9
Lab 6 — Change Enablement, Release and Deployment.....	10
Lab 7 — Service Level Management, Continual Improvement and Metrics.....	10
Lab 8 — ITIL Capstone and Exam Readiness.....	11
Key Distinctions and Quick References.....	11
Next Steps.....	13
Glossary.....	13

Introduction

Use this guide alongside the course slides and the in-class group activities. ITIL 4 Foundation is a knowledge-based course: the activities are group discussions, case-study analyses and scenario triage exercises rather than software labs, so the value comes from working through the reasoning with your group and defending your conclusions to the class.

Definitions matter in ITIL. Many exam questions turn on the precise distinction between two similar terms — output and outcome, utility and warranty, incident and problem, service request and incident. Where this guide gives a definition, learn it as written.

Course Learning Outcomes

- LO1: Explain the key concepts of service management, including services, value, outcomes, costs, risks, utility and warranty, and the roles of service providers and consumers.
- LO2: Apply the seven ITIL guiding principles to service management decisions and improvement initiatives in the workplace.
- LO3: Describe the four dimensions of service management and evaluate how each dimension affects the delivery of a service.
- LO4: Explain the ITIL service value system and the six service value chain activities, and apply the continual improvement model.
- LO5: Describe the purpose of the key ITIL practices and apply them to incident, problem, change and service request scenarios.

Before You Start — Preparation

What you need

- No prior ITIL certification or technical prerequisite is required.
- Familiarity with an IT support, IT operations or service delivery environment is helpful but not essential.
- Bring a real service or workplace situation to discuss — several activities ask you to apply ITIL concepts to your own organisation.
- Pen and paper (or a laptop) for the lab worksheets and group presentations.

Verify your setup

No software setup is required — the labs are worksheet and discussion based.

Conventions used in every lab

- Each activity states the learning outcome it maps to, so you can trace it back to the exam domains.

- Activities are done in small groups of 2–3 persons; each group presents its findings to the class.
- The 'Test it' check at the end of each activity is the standard your group's output should meet.
- Key ITIL terms appear in the Glossary at the end of this guide — learn the exact definitions.
- Record the assumptions your group makes; being able to justify an assumption is part of the skill.

Topic 01 — Understand Key Concepts of Service Management (25%)

Services · Value · Outcomes, Costs and Risks · Providers and Consumers · Utility and Warranty

Key concepts

- A service is a means of enabling value co-creation by facilitating outcomes customers want to achieve, without the customer having to manage specific costs and risks.
- Service management is a set of specialised organisational capabilities for enabling value to customers in the form of services.
- Value is co-created through an active relationship between the service provider and the service consumer.
- Service consumers take on the roles of customer, user and sponsor; providers deliver service offerings made up of goods, access to resources and service actions.
- Outputs are deliverables of an activity; outcomes are the results a stakeholder actually achieves, enabled by those outputs.
- Utility is what the service does (fit for purpose); warranty is how the service performs (fit for use).

Lab 1 — Service Management, Value Co-Creation, Utility and Warranty

Learning outcome: Explain services, value co-creation, outputs vs outcomes, costs, risks, utility and warranty (LO1).

Goal: Work the BrightDesk Employee Digital Workplace scenario: identify the service, provider, consumer and users; separate outputs from outcomes; define utility and warranty; and map the costs and risks the service imposes on and removes from the consumer.

What you'll build

The completed lab worksheet for this activity. (Tools: Lab worksheet, ITIL 4 Foundation slides, Learner Guide.)

Step-by-step

1. Work through labs/lab-01 in your group, completing every step and table.

Test it

Your group can state the service, its provider, consumer roles and users; separates every output from its outcome; and defends its utility, warranty, cost and risk mappings.

Note: Full commands and screenshots are in labs/lab-01-*.md. Work the labs with your group on the shared BrightDesk Services scenario.

Topic 02 — ITIL Guiding Principles (20%)

Focus on Value · Start Where You Are · Progress Iteratively · Collaborate · Think Holistically · Keep It Simple · Optimize and Automate

Key concepts

- A guiding principle is a recommendation that guides an organisation in all circumstances, regardless of changes in goals, strategies or type of work.
- Focus on value: everything the organisation does should link back, directly or indirectly, to value for itself, its customers and its stakeholders.
- Start where you are: assess and reuse what already exists rather than discarding it and rebuilding from scratch.
- Progress iteratively with feedback: organise work into smaller manageable sections, executed and completed in a timely manner, using feedback at each iteration.
- Collaborate and promote visibility: involve the right people in the right roles to improve buy-in, relevance and the likelihood of long-term success.
- Think and work holistically, keep it simple and practical, and optimize before you automate.

Lab 2 — Seven Guiding Principles and Decision Scenarios

Learning outcome: Apply the seven ITIL guiding principles to service management decisions (LO2).

Goal: Apply each of the seven guiding principles to a set of BrightDesk decision scenarios, stating what the principle would have you do — and stop doing — in each case.

What you'll build

The completed lab worksheet for this activity. (Tools: Lab worksheet, ITIL 4 Foundation slides, Learner Guide.)

Step-by-step

1. Work through labs/lab-02 in your group, completing every step and table.

Test it

Your group can name all seven guiding principles and, for each decision scenario, justify which principle applies and what it changes in practice.

Note: Full commands and screenshots are in labs/lab-02-*.md. Work the labs with your group on the shared BrightDesk Services scenario.

Topic 03 — The Four Dimensions of Service Management (15%)

Organizations and People · Information and Technology · Partners and Suppliers · Value Streams and Processes

Key concepts

- The four dimensions ensure a holistic approach to service management; every component of the SVS must be considered from all four.
- Organizations and people covers roles, responsibilities, structures, culture and the competencies needed to deliver the service.
- Information and technology covers the information and knowledge required, plus the technologies that support and enable the service.
- Partners and suppliers covers relationships with other organisations involved in the design, deployment, delivery and support of services.
- Value streams and processes covers how the parts of the organisation work together, in an integrated and coordinated way, to enable value creation.
- External factors — political, economic, social, technological, legal and environmental (PESTLE) — constrain and shape all four dimensions.

Lab 3 — Four Dimensions of Service Management

Learning outcome: Evaluate a service across the four dimensions of service management and PESTLE factors (LO3).

Goal: Analyse the BrightDesk service across organizations and people, information and technology, partners and suppliers, and value streams and processes; apply PESTLE to the external factors; and identify the weakest dimension.

What you'll build

The completed lab worksheet for this activity. (Tools: Lab worksheet, ITIL 4 Foundation slides, Learner Guide.)

Step-by-step

1. Work through labs/lab-03 in your group, completing every step and table.

Test it

Your group has findings under all four dimensions, has applied PESTLE to the external factors, and can defend which dimension is the weakest and why.

Note: Full commands and screenshots are in labs/lab-03-*.md. Work the labs with your group on the shared BrightDesk Services scenario.

Topic 04 — The Service Value System (20%)

ITIL SVS · Plan · Improve · Engage · Design and Transition · Obtain/Build · Deliver and Support

Key concepts

- The ITIL service value system describes how all components and activities of the organisation work together as a system to enable value creation.
- The SVS comprises guiding principles, governance, the service value chain, practices and continual improvement; its inputs are opportunity and demand.
- The service value chain is a set of six interconnected activities an organisation performs to deliver a valuable product or service to its consumers.
- Plan ensures a shared understanding of vision, status and improvement direction; improve ensures continual improvement of products, services and practices.
- Engage provides understanding of stakeholder needs and transparency; design and transition ensures products and services continually meet expectations.
- The continual improvement model runs from 'What is the vision?' through to 'How do we keep the momentum going?' in seven steps.

Lab 4 — Service Value System and Service Value Chain

Learning outcome: Explain the ITIL service value system and the six service value chain activities (LO4).

Goal: Map the BrightDesk SVS: identify opportunity and demand as inputs, then trace a request through the six value chain activities, listing the inputs and outputs of each.

What you'll build

The completed lab worksheet for this activity. (Tools: Lab worksheet, ITIL 4 Foundation slides, Learner Guide.)

Step-by-step

1. Work through labs/lab-04 in your group, completing every step and table.

Test it

Your group has traced a request end-to-end through all six value chain activities, with a named input and output for each activity.

Note: Full commands and screenshots are in labs/lab-04-*.md. Work the labs with your group on the shared BrightDesk Services scenario.

Topic 05 — ITIL Practices (20%)

Continual Improvement · Change Enablement · Incident · Problem · Service Request · Service Desk · Service Level Management

Key concepts

- A practice is a set of organisational resources designed for performing work or accomplishing an objective; ITIL 4 defines 34 practices in three groups.
- Incident management minimises the negative impact of incidents by restoring normal service operation as quickly as possible.
- Problem management reduces the likelihood and impact of incidents by identifying actual and potential causes; a known error is an analysed problem not yet resolved.
- Change enablement maximises the number of successful IT changes by ensuring risks are properly assessed and changes authorised by a change authority.
- The service desk captures demand for incident resolution and service requests, and is the entry point and single point of contact for users.
- Service level management sets clear business-based targets for service performance, documented in service level agreements (SLAs).

Lab 5 — Incident, Problem, Service Request, Service Desk

Learning outcome: Apply incident, problem, service request and service desk practices to real contacts (LO5).

Goal: Triage a morning's BrightDesk contacts: classify each as an incident, problem, known error or service request, justify the classification, and design the handling path.

What you'll build

The completed lab worksheet for this activity. (Tools: Lab worksheet, ITIL 4 Foundation slides, Learner Guide.)

Step-by-step

1. Work through labs/lab-05 in your group, completing every step and table.

Test it

Your group has classified every contact in the morning's queue as incident, problem, known error or service request, and can justify each handling path.

Note: Full commands and screenshots are in labs/lab-05-*.md. Work the labs with your group on the shared BrightDesk Services scenario.

Lab 6 — Change Enablement, Release and Deployment

Learning outcome: Apply change enablement and distinguish change types, change authorities, release and deployment (LO5).

Goal: Classify BrightDesk changes as standard, normal or emergency; assign the right change authority; and distinguish deployment from release.

What you'll build

The completed lab worksheet for this activity. (Tools: Lab worksheet, ITIL 4 Foundation slides, Learner Guide.)

Step-by-step

1. Work through labs/lab-06 in your group, completing every step and table.

Test it

Your group has classified every change as standard, normal or emergency with the right change authority, and can state the difference between release and deployment.

Note: Full commands and screenshots are in labs/lab-06-*.md. Work the labs with your group on the shared BrightDesk Services scenario.

Lab 7 — Service Level Management, Continual Improvement and Metrics

Learning outcome: Apply service level management and the continual improvement model to service performance (LO5, LO4).

Goal: Write business-based SLA targets for the BrightDesk service, avoid the watermelon SLA, and run the seven-step continual improvement model against a real shortfall.

What you'll build

The completed lab worksheet for this activity. (Tools: Lab worksheet, ITIL 4 Foundation slides, Learner Guide.)

Step-by-step

1. Work through labs/lab-07 in your group, completing every step and table.

Test it

Your group has business-based SLA targets (not just technical metrics) and a completed seven-step continual improvement plan for the shortfall.

Note: Full commands and screenshots are in labs/lab-07-*.md. Work the labs with your group on the shared BrightDesk Services scenario.

Lab 8 — ITIL Capstone and Exam Readiness

Learning outcome: Consolidate all five topics and rehearse ITIL 4 Foundation exam-style questions (LO1–LO5).

Goal: Bring the whole course together on the BrightDesk improvement case, then work exam-style questions across all five topics.

What you'll build

The completed lab worksheet for this activity. (Tools: Lab worksheet, ITIL 4 Foundation slides, Learner Guide.)

Step-by-step

1. Work through labs/lab-08 in your group, completing every step and table.

Test it

Your group has completed the BrightDesk improvement case and reviewed its answers to the exam-style questions across all five topics.

Note: Full commands and screenshots are in labs/lab-08-*.md. Work the labs with your group on the shared BrightDesk Services scenario.

Key Distinctions and Quick References

Foundation-level exam questions frequently test whether you can separate closely related terms. Be able to state each difference in one sentence and give an example of each.

Output vs Outcome

- Output — a tangible or intangible deliverable of an activity (a delivered package, a completed task, a generated report).
- Outcome — a result for a stakeholder, enabled by one or more outputs (the stakeholder can now do something they could not before).
- Test: if you can hand it over, it is an output; if it is a change in the stakeholder's situation, it is an outcome.

Utility vs Warranty

- Utility — what the service DOES; the functionality offered to meet a particular need. Fit for purpose.
- Warranty — how the service PERFORMS; availability, capacity, reliability, security and continuity. Fit for use.
- A service needs BOTH to deliver value: functionality that is unavailable delivers nothing.

Incident vs Problem vs Known Error

- Incident — an unplanned interruption to a service, or a reduction in the quality of a service. Restore service as quickly as possible.
- Problem — a cause, or potential cause, of one or more incidents. Reduce likelihood and impact.
- Known error — a problem that has been analysed and has not been resolved. Often managed with a workaround.
- Workaround — a solution that reduces or eliminates the impact of an incident or problem for which a full resolution is not yet available.

Service Request vs Incident

- Service request — a request from a user or their authorised representative that initiates a normal, pre-defined service action.
- Incident — something is broken or degraded that should not be.
- Test: was the service working as designed? If yes and the user simply wants something, it is a service request.

Quick Reference — The Seven Guiding Principles

- Focus on value — everything links back, directly or indirectly, to value for the organisation, its customers and its stakeholders.
- Start where you are — assess and reuse what already exists rather than discarding it and rebuilding.
- Progress iteratively with feedback — organise work into smaller sections, using feedback at each iteration.
- Collaborate and promote visibility — involve the right people in the right roles; make work visible.
- Think and work holistically — no service, practice, process, department or supplier stands alone.
- Keep it simple and practical — use the minimum number of steps to accomplish an objective.
- Optimize and automate — optimize the process first, then automate; never automate a broken process.

Quick Reference — The Six Service Value Chain Activities

- Plan — ensures a shared understanding of the vision, current status and improvement direction.
- Improve — ensures continual improvement of products, services and practices across all value chain activities.
- Engage — provides a good understanding of stakeholder needs, transparency and continual engagement.
- Design and transition — ensures products and services continually meet stakeholder expectations for quality, cost and time to market.
- Obtain/build — ensures service components are available when and where needed, and meet agreed specifications.
- Deliver and support — ensures services are delivered and supported according to agreed specifications and stakeholder expectations.

Next Steps

- Book your ITIL 4 Foundation exam using the voucher included with this course while the material is fresh.
- Review the key concepts and definitions in each topic of this guide — many exam questions hinge on exact definitions.
- Re-read the seven guiding principles and be able to apply each to a written scenario.
- Memorise the purpose statements of the ITIL practices covered in Topic 5.
- Attempt the practice exam and review every explanation:
<https://exams.tertiaryinfotech.com/practice-exams/axelos/axelos-iti4-foundation>
- Revisit any topic whose questions you miss, then re-take the practice exam.

Glossary

- **Service** — A means of enabling value co-creation by facilitating outcomes that customers want to achieve, without the customer having to manage specific costs and risks.
- **Service management** — A set of specialised organisational capabilities for enabling value to customers in the form of services.
- **Value** — The perceived benefits, usefulness and importance of something.
- **Value co-creation** — Value is created jointly by the provider and the consumer through an active service relationship — not delivered one way.
- **Output** — A tangible or intangible deliverable of an activity.
- **Outcome** — A result for a stakeholder, enabled by one or more outputs.
- **Utility** — The functionality offered by a product or service to meet a particular need — 'fit for purpose'.
- **Warranty** — Assurance that a product or service will meet agreed requirements — 'fit for use'.

- **Service offering** — A formal description of one or more services, designed to address the needs of a target consumer group; may include goods, access to resources and service actions.
- **Service relationship** — A cooperation between a service provider and a service consumer to co-create value.
- **Customer / User / Sponsor** — The consumer roles: the customer defines requirements and owns the outcomes; the user uses the service; the sponsor authorises the budget.
- **Service value system (SVS)** — How all the components and activities of the organisation work together as a system to enable value creation.
- **Service value chain** — The set of six interconnected activities an organisation performs to deliver a valuable product or service.
- **Practice** — A set of organisational resources designed for performing work or accomplishing an objective. ITIL 4 defines 34 practices.
- **Guiding principle** — A recommendation that guides an organisation in all circumstances, regardless of changes in goals, strategies or type of work.
- **Continual improvement** — A recurring organisational activity performed at all levels to ensure performance continually meets stakeholder expectations.
- **Incident** — An unplanned interruption to a service, or a reduction in the quality of a service.
- **Problem** — A cause, or potential cause, of one or more incidents.
- **Known error** — A problem that has been analysed and has not been resolved.
- **Workaround** — A solution that reduces or eliminates the impact of an incident or problem for which a full resolution is not yet available.
- **Service request** — A request from a user or a user's authorised representative that initiates a normal, pre-defined service action.
- **Change** — The addition, modification or removal of anything that could have a direct or indirect effect on services.
- **Change authority** — The person or group who authorises a change.
- **Configuration item (CI)** — Any component that needs to be managed in order to deliver an IT service.
- **Service level agreement (SLA)** — A documented agreement between a service provider and a customer identifying both the services required and the expected level of service.
- **Event** — Any change of state that has significance for the management of a service or other configuration item.
- **Four dimensions** — Organizations and people; information and technology; partners and suppliers; value streams and processes.
- **PESTLE** — Political, economic, social, technological, legal and environmental — the external factors that constrain an organisation.